SSC CHSL 2021 Tier-I question paper with answers

2 June 2022 · Shift 3

77 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 23 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20220816140307/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2021_16082022.pdf

English Language 18 questions

Q.1

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. I suggested her two _____ dates, both in the coming month and just a few days _____ from each other to start her singing practice.

(A) alarming, near
(B) adverse, different
(C) alternative, apart
(D) alternating, closely

Q.2

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A.People can get in touch with the larger global community by communicating and sharing their views via social media. B.Furthermore, this provides a suitable platform to express their views, conduct business with online transactions, or find new people or jobs. C.Smartphones have become a very important form of communication these days. D.It is impossible for a rational person to deny the advantages of smartphones as they are devices suitable for a wide variety of tasks

(A) CBDA
(B) CDAB
(C) DCBA
(D) ABCD

Q.3

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Desiderate

(A) Quarrel
(B) Disregard
(C) Acquire
(D) Mandate

Q.4

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Inscrutable
(B) Banality
(C) Conscientous
(D) Giddyap

Q.6

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice. The outcome of the interview will be published by next week.

(A) The panel will have published the outcome of the interview by the week next.
(B) The panel would have published the outcome of the interview by next week.
(C) The panel was to publish the outcome of the interview by next week.
(D) The panel will publish the outcome of the interview by next week.

Q.10

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Charley horse

(A) Very fast
(B) Lucky
(C) Cramp
(D) Cunning

Q.11

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice. The national flag was hoisted by the minister.

(A) The minister hoist the national flag.
(B) The minister was hoisted the national flag.
(C) The minister hoisted the national flag.
(D) The minister will hoist the national flag.

Q.12

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Prerna is in a great_____ about whether to go for the party or not.

(A) pain
(B) depression
(C) dilemma
(D) distress

Q.15

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined words in the given sentence. In order to restore peace, the Czar “renounced the throne” in favour of his first cousin.

(A) abdicated
(B) stepped
(C) sacrificed
(D) sacrileged

Q.17

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice. Children like to play games all the time.

(A) Children like being played to games all the time.
(B) Games liked playing with children all the time
(C) Games are liked to be played by children all the time.
(D) Children are being played games all the time.

Q.18

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Boldness

(A) Eagerness
(B) Hard-heartedness
(C) Wisdom
(D) Bravery

Q.19

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. One must care “as for family members” as possible.

(A) most for family members
(B) as most for family members
(C) more for family members
(D) as much for family members

Q.20

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A person who leaves his/her own country to live in another country permanently

(A) Vagabond
(B) Mercenary
(C) Emigrant
(D) Immigrant

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Just before midnight he put on warm clothes and his new shoes and (1)_____ across the bridge. He turned (2)_____ the road and along the sound below the church. Ice had formed on the sound and inside the old harbor, but further out he could see a darker belt of (3)_____ water. As he stood there, the lights on the (4)_____ of the church went out, and it was dark all around him. It was (5)_____ cold and stars filled the sky.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) danced
(B) stalked
(C) slept
(D) walked

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Just before midnight he put on warm clothes and his new shoes and (1)_____ across the bridge. He turned (2)_____ the road and along the sound below the church. Ice had formed on the sound and inside the old harbor, but further out he could see a darker belt of (3)_____ water. As he stood there, the lights on the (4)_____ of the church went out, and it was dark all around him. It was (5)_____ cold and stars filled the sky.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) under
(B) inside
(C) off
(D) over

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Just before midnight he put on warm clothes and his new shoes and (1)_____ across the bridge. He turned (2)_____ the road and along the sound below the church. Ice had formed on the sound and inside the old harbor, but further out he could see a darker belt of (3)_____ water. As he stood there, the lights on the (4)_____ of the church went out, and it was dark all around him. It was (5)_____ cold and stars filled the sky.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) wet
(B) closed
(C) dried
(D) open

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Just before midnight he put on warm clothes and his new shoes and (1)_____ across the bridge. He turned (2)_____ the road and along the sound below the church. Ice had formed on the sound and inside the old harbor, but further out he could see a darker belt of (3)_____ water. As he stood there, the lights on the (4)_____ of the church went out, and it was dark all around him. It was (5)_____ cold and stars filled the sky.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) architecture
(B) tunnel
(C) vent
(D) façade

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Just before midnight he put on warm clothes and his new shoes and (1)_____ across the bridge. He turned (2)_____ the road and along the sound below the church. Ice had formed on the sound and inside the old harbor, but further out he could see a darker belt of (3)_____ water. As he stood there, the lights on the (4)_____ of the church went out, and it was dark all around him. It was (5)_____ cold and stars filled the sky.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) some
(B) abundantly
(C) sparingly
(D) icy

General Intelligence 19 questions

Q.2

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 641, 647, 659, 673, 683, ?

(A) 711
(B) 715
(C) 701
(D) 705

Q.3

Select the option that represents the correct order of the given words as they would appear in an English dictionary. 1.Prophet 2.Prudent 3.Producer 4.Quest 5.Puberty 6.Profound

(A) 3,5,6,1,2,4
(B) 3,6,2,1,5,4
(C) 3,1,6,5,2,4
(D) 3,6,1,2,5,4

Q.4

Select the option that represents the letters that, when sequentially placed from left to right in the blanks below, will complete the letter series. T _ _ r S S_ T T r _ _ S u T T r r_ _ u

(A) T r u r S S S
(B) T r u r T S S
(C) T r u r S r T
(D) S r u r S S S

Q.5

The second number in the given number-pairs is obtained by performing certain mathematical operation(s) on the first number. The same operation(s) are followed in all the number-pairs EXCEPT one. Find that odd number-pair.

(A) 3 : 14
(B) 5 : 63
(C) 7 : 172
(D) 9 : 355

Q.7

Select the option that is related to the third word in the same way as the second word is related to the first word. (The words must be considered as meaningful English words and must NOT be related to each other based on the number of letters/number of consonants/vowels in the word) Watch : Wrist :: Clock : ?

(A) House
(B) Wall
(C) Room
(D) Shop

Q.8

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to sequentially replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 25*5*10*2*4*7

(A) ×, ÷,−,+, =
(B) −,+,÷,×,=
(C) ÷,+,−,×, =
(D) ÷,×,−,+, =

Q.9

In a certain code language, 'SKATE' is written as '191122010' and 'ROLLER' is written as '183012121018'. How will 'SLIDE' be written in that language?

(A) 191218412
(B) 191218416
(C) 191218414
(D) 191218410

Q.10

In a certain code language, “ENSURE” is written as “FPVTPB”, and “EQUITY” is written as “FSXHRV”. How will “FINGER” be written in that language?

(A) GJQFCO
(B) GKRFCO
(C) GKQFDO
(D) GKQFCO

Q.11

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 1, 24, 58, 125, 247, 446, ?

(A) 774
(B) 747
(C) 744
(D) 777

Q.12

If 15th October 2008 was a Wednesday, then what was the day of the week on 14th October 2012?

(A) Sunday
(B) Saturday
(C) Tuesday
(D) Monday

Q.13

In a certain code language, “MATURE” is written as “AMUTER”, and “MENTAL” is written as “EMTNLA”. How will “MOBILE” be written in that language?

(A) OMIEBL
(B) OMIBEL
(C) OIMEBL
(D) OIMBEL

Q.14

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 18 : 55 :: 28 : 85 :: 36 : ?

(A) 105
(B) 115
(C) 109
(D) 104

Q.17

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to sequentially replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 17*18*6*5*2*10

(A) ×, −, ÷, +, =
(B) ×, −, +, ÷, =
(C) +, ÷, −, ×, =
(D) +, ×, ÷, −, =

Q.18

Three Statements are given followed by Three conclusions numbered I, II and III. Assuming the statements to be true, even if they seem to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All ‘alphas’ are ‘betas’. No ‘beta’ is a ‘gamma’. Some ‘thetas’ are ‘alphas’. Conclusions: I. Some gammas are alphas. II. Some thetas are betas. III. No alpha is a gamma.

(A) Only conclusion II follows.
(B) Only conclusion I follows.
(C) Both conclusions II and III follow.
(D) Both conclusions I and II follow.

Q.19

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 1778, 1609, 1465, 1344, 1244, ?

(A) 1144
(B) 1109
(C) 1178
(D) 1163

Q.20

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 17*4*63*7*21*3*59

(A) ×,+,÷,−,+,=
(B) =,−,×,+,−,÷
(C) −,×,+,=,÷,−
(D) =,−,×,+,÷, −

Q.21

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and fourth term related to third term. 27:81 :: 18:36 :: 33:?

(A) 121
(B) 135
(C) 125
(D) 131

Q.23

Which letter-cluster will replace the question mark (?) to complete the given series? GOWB, MVEK, SCMT, ?, EQCL

(A) YKUC
(B) YKCU
(C) YJCU
(D) YJUC

Q.24

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 25 * 3 * 5 * 15 * 1

(A) =, +, +, +
(B) +, =, +, −
(C) ÷, ×, ×, =
(D) ×, =, ×, ×

Quantitative Aptitude 15 questions

Q.2

Vinod had ₹10,000 with him. He lent a part of it at 8% per annum simple interest and the remaining at 10% per annum. His total annual income was ₹880. Find the sum lent at 8%.

(A) ₹5,500
(B) ₹6,000
(C) ₹5,000
(D) ₹6,500

Q.4

Namitha gives a 20% discount on all things in her shop and yet makes a profit of 12%. What is the cost price of an item with marked price of ₹280?

(A) ₹215
(B) ₹210
(C) ₹212
(D) ₹200

Q.5

Aman has taken a loan of ₹50,000 from a bank at the rate of 8% to be compounded annually. How much does he have to pay after 3 years? (Nearest to a ₹)

(A) ₹62,517
(B) ₹62,871
(C) ₹62,986
(D) ₹62,000

Q.6

A man runs 200 metres in 24 seconds. His speed is:

(A) 30 km/h
(B) 32 km/h
(C) 24 km/h
(D) 33 km/h

Q.8

If x is the fourth proportional of 48, 72 and 108, what is the value of x?

(A) 72
(B) 144
(C) 120
(D) 162

Q.9

In an election between Ram and Shyamal, one got 30% of the total votes and thus lost by 900 votes. If 90% of the voters voted and no invalid or illegal votes were cast, then what was the numbers of voters in the voting list?

(A) 2800
(B) 2500
(C) 2700
(D) 2300

Q.12

Which one of the following numbers is divisible by 24?

(A) 569896
(B) 478656
(C) 480128
(D) 543344

Q.13

While travelling from Nashik to Daman, Harsh drove for 1 hour at a speed of 50 km/h and for the next three hours at 60 km/h. What was his average speed for the whole trip?

(A) 56 km/h
(B) 57.5 km/h
(C) 55 km/h
(D) 58.5 km/h

Q.14

6 men or 2 women or 4 boys can finish a work in 77 days. How many days will 1 man, 1 woman and 1 boy together take to finish the same work?

(A) 86
(B) 80
(C) 84
(D) 82

Q.15

Raghuvir purchased some perishable items for sale but 36% of those items could not be sold and went bad. However, Raghuvir managed to sell the rest of the items at a price that helped him earn an overall profit of 28%. At what percentage above the cost price of each item did Raghuvir sell each of the items that did not go bad?

(A) 100%
(B) 92%
(C) 63%
(D) 120%

Q.16

After melting three cubes of sides 6 cm, 8 cm and 10 cm, a big cube is made. Find the side of the new cube.

(A) 13 cm
(B) 24 cm
(C) 25 cm
(D) 12 cm

Q.19

The length of each side of a regular hexagon is 10 cm. What is the area of the hexagon?

(A) $156\sqrt{3}$ cm²
(B) $144\sqrt{3}$ cm²
(C) $148\sqrt{3}$ cm²
(D) $150\sqrt{3}$ cm²

Q.21

The area of a square is $9m^2 + 12m + 4$. Find the measure of the side of the square.

(A) 3m + 2
(B) 3m + 4
(C) $3m^2 + 2$
(D) $3m^2 + 2m$

Q.24

A way of punching data that exhibits the values of the variables and corresponding frequencies is called:

(A) an array
(B) frequency of observation
(C) raw data
(D) frequency distribution

Q.25

Two tangents TP and TQ are drawn to a circle with centre O from an external point T. If TP = 7 cm, find the length of TQ.

(A) 7 cm
(B) 10.5 cm
(C) 3.5 cm
(D) 14 cm

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

Which of the following novels is written by Mulk Raj Anand that shows the cruelty of the caste system based on pre-independence era of India?

(A) The Village
(B) Untouchable
(C) Across the Black Waters
(D) Coolie

Q.2

Which organisation was created in 1988 by the World Meteorological Organization (WMO) and the United Nations Environment Program (UNEP) to assess the science related to climate change?

(A) Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC)
(B) International Climate Action Network (ICAN)
(C) Global Climate Growth Institute (GCGI)
(D) Australian Youth Climate Coalition (AYCC)

Q.3

In the ancient times, which river was also known as 'Pooni' in Tamil which is the fourth largest river flowing in the southeast direction through the states of Karnataka and Tamil Nadu?

(A) Kaveri River
(B) Satluj River
(C) Ravi River
(D) Tapi River

Q.4

The term 'off break' is used in which of the following sports?

(A) Football
(B) Hockey
(C) Badminton
(D) Cricket

Q.5

Who among the following has written the Hindi novel ‘Kafan’?

(A) Sumitranandan Pant
(B) Mahadevi Verma
(C) Jaishankar Prasad
(D) Premchand

Q.6

_____ is a situation in the bonds market when the rate of interest falls to its lowest level and the speculative demand for money becomes perfectly elastic.

(A) Cash crunch
(B) Infinite supply
(C) Liquidity trap
(D) Zero money velocity

Q.7

Which Indian musician won the Grammys in 2015 in the Best New Age Album category, his album Winds of Samsara was a collaboration with a South African falutist Wouter Kellerman?

(A) Alokananda Dasgupta
(B) Sadhu Kokila
(C) Rickey Kej
(D) Stephen Devassy

Q.8

Three Indians were named amongst Time Magazine's '100 Most Influential People' of 2021. Who among the following is NOT one of them?

(A) Gautam Adani
(B) Narendra Modi
(C) Mamata Banerjee
(D) Adar Poonawalla

Q.9

Who among the following is known as Sarangi instrumentalist?

(A) T.N Krishnan
(B) T Brinda
(C) T.M Krishna
(D) Ustad Bundu Khan

Q.10

2021 marked the 145th birth anniversary of the designer of the Indian National Tricolour. What was his/her name?

(A) Madame Bhikaji Cama
(B) Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay
(C) Pingali Venkayya
(D) Annie Besant

Q.11

What is the percentage of land used for agriculture in India as per the 2009 data by National Institute of Hydrology?

(A) 51.09%
(B) 50.09%
(C) 59.09%
(D) 59.01%

Q.12

Sonal Mansingh, the classical dance legend, has NOT received which of the following awards?

(A) Sangeet Natak Akademi Award
(B) Padma Vibhushan
(C) Padma Shri
(D) Padma Bhushan

Q.13

Who among the following Indian musicians introduced shehnai to the concert stage and was selected to perform for the ceremony at Delhi's historic Red Fort on the occasion of India's Independence Day on 15 August 1947?

(A) Ali Bakhsh
(B) Anant Lal
(C) Bismillah Khan
(D) Ali Ahmad Hussain

Q.14

The autobiography 'Unbreakable: An Autobiography' is written by which of the following sportspersons of India?

(A) Yuvraj Singh
(B) M C Mary Kom
(C) Abhinav Bindra
(D) P T Usha

Q.15
Davis Cup is associated with which of the following sports?

(A) Badminton
(B) Football
(C) Hockey
(D) Tennis

Q.16
What kind of substances are separated using the technique of steam distillation?

(A) Coloured substances
(B) Substances with many electrons
(C) Coarse substances
(D) Substances that are steam volatile

Q.17
Identify the acid that helps in digestion.

(A) Nitric acid
(B) Acetic acid
(C) Hydrochloric acid
(D) Sulphuric acid

Q.18
DDT adversely affects our environment because:

(A) it can kill beneficial insects like honey bees
(B) it can allow growth of harmful insects
(C) it can promote growth of harmful insects
(D) it can kill harmful insects

Q.19
Which of the following Indian classical singers was known as Mallika-e-Ghazal or the Queen of Ghazal and got appreciations by the Nightingale of India, Sarojini Naidu at the age of fifteen?

(A) Chitra Singh
(B) Begum Akhtar
(C) Suraiya
(D) Amrutha Suresh

Q.20
Which of the following Odissi dancers is also a master of percussion instruments like Mridangam, Pakhavaj and Tabla?

(A) Kelucharan Mohapatra
(B) Sujata Mohapatra
(C) Ramani Ranjan Jena
(D) Sudhakar Sahoo

Q.21
Which unicellular organism acquires food by a process in which cells absorb external material by engulfing it with the cell membrane?

(A) Yeast
(B) Volvox
(C) Amoeba
(D) Spirogyra

Q.22
Which of the following Indian classical Bharatanatyam dancers received the honours of Padma Shri in 1981 and Padma Bhushan in 2003?

(A) Savitha Sastry
(B) Mallika Sarabhai
(C) Rukmini Devi
(D) Padma Subrahmanyam

Q.23
Mallika Sarabhai, a Kuchipudi and Bharatanatyam dancer, was awarded with the Padma Bhushan in which of the following years?

(A) 2012
(B) 2008
(C) 2006
(D) 2010

Q.24

In February 2022, which of the following persons was nominated for Laureus 'World Breakthrough of the Year' award?

(A) Max Parrot
(B) Sachin Tendulkar
(C) Neeraj Chopra
(D) Vinesh Phogat

Q.25

_____ of the Constitution of India provides protection against arrest and detention in certain cases.

(A) Article 25
(B) Article 22
(C) Article 23
(D) Article 20

Answer key

English Language

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.6 **(D)**	Q.10 **(C)**
Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(D)**
Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(D)**

General Intelligence

Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(C)**
Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(C)**
Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.23 **(D)**
Q.24 **(D)**					

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.2 **(B)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(A)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(B)**
Q.12 **(B)**	Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.19 **(D)**
Q.21 **(A)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(A)**			

General Awareness

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

Explanations

English Language

Q.1 · Answer (C) alternative, apart

The two dates are 'alternative' choices, a few days 'apart' from each other.

Q.2 · Answer (B) CDAB

C introduces smartphones as a means of communication, D their many uses, A one of them (social media), and B, opening with 'Furthermore', adds more: CDAB.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Disregard

To 'desiderate' is to long for something one lacks; its opposite is to 'disregard'.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Conscientous

The correct spelling is 'conscientious'. ('Giddyap', a call urging a horse on, is a real word.)

Q.6 · Answer (D) The panel will publish the outcome of the interview by next week.

The future passive 'will be published' becomes the simple future active 'will publish', with a doer supplied: 'The panel will publish the outcome of the interview by next week.'

Q.10 · Answer (C) Cramp

A 'charley horse' is a cramp or stiffness in a muscle, usually in the leg.

Q.11 · Answer (C) The minister hoisted the national flag.

The simple past passive 'was hoisted by' becomes the simple past active: 'The minister hoisted the national flag.'

Q.12 · Answer (C) dilemma

To be 'in a dilemma' is to be unable to choose between two courses: here, going to the party or not.

Q.15 · Answer (A) abdicated

To 'abdicate' is to give up a throne formally.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Games are liked to be played by children all the time.

The object 'games' becomes the subject, 'like to play' becomes 'are liked to be played', and the doer follows 'by': 'by children'.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Bravery

'Boldness' is willingness to face danger or take risks: 'bravery'.

Q.19 · Answer (D) as much for family members

'As much … as possible' means as far as one can: 'One must care as much for family members as possible.'

Q.20 · Answer (C) Emigrant

An emigrant leaves his or her own country to settle in another; to the new country he or she is an immigrant.

Q.21 · Answer (D) walked

Dressed in his new shoes, he 'walked' across the bridge; 'stalked' suggests stiff, angry striding or following prey.

Q.22 · Answer (C) off

To 'turn off' a road is to leave it for another way, here along the sound.

Q.23 · Answer (D) open

Ice had formed near the shore, but further out lay a belt of 'open' water, not frozen over.

Q.24 · Answer (D) façade

The lights on the 'façade', the front of the church, went out.

Q.25 · Answer (D) icy

'Icy cold' means extremely cold, as a night of ice and stars would be.

General Intelligence

Q.2 · Answer (C) 701

Each term is the second prime number after the one before: 641, (643), 647, (653), 659, (661), 673, (677), 683, (691), 701.

Q.3 · Answer (D) 3,6,1,2,5,4

In dictionary order: Producer (3), Profound (6), Prophet (1), Prudent (2), Puberty (5), Quest (4). 'Prod', 'Prof' and 'Prop' come in that order, then 'Pru', 'Pu' and 'Q'.

Q.4 · Answer (A) T r u r S S S

With T, r, u, r, S, S, S in the blanks the block TTrrSSu repeats: TTrrSSu TTrrSSu TTrrSSu.

Q.5 · Answer (D) 9 : 355

In the other pairs the second number is (first^3 + 1)/2: (27 + 1)/2 = 14, (125 + 1)/2 = 63 and (343 + 1)/2 = 172. For 9 it would be (729 + 1)/2 = 365, not 355.

Q.7 · Answer (B) Wall

A watch is worn on the wrist, as a clock is hung on a wall.

Q.8 · Answer (C) ÷,+,–,×, =

25 ÷ 5 + 10 – 2 × 4 = 5 + 10 – 8 = 7.

Q.9 · Answer (D) 191218410

Each letter is written as its place in the alphabet, with the vowels' places doubled: S K A T E → 19, 11, 2, 20, 10 and R O L L E R → 18, 30, 12, 12, 10, 18. So S L I D E → 19, 12, 18, 4, 10: 191218410.

Q.10 · Answer (D) GKQFCO

The letters move +1, +2, +3, –1, –2, –3: ENSURE → FPVTPB and EQUITY → FSXHRV. So FINGER → GKQFCO.

Q.11 · Answer (C) 744

The differences are 23, 34, 67, 122, 199, and their own differences, 11, 33, 55, 77, grow by 22. The next is 99, so the next difference is 199 + 99 = 298: 446 + 298 = 744.

Q.12 · Answer (A) Sunday

From 15 October 2008 to 15 October 2012 is four years including 29 February 2012: 1,461 days, 208 weeks and 5 days. Wednesday + 5 = Monday, so 14 October 2012 was a Sunday.

Q.13 · Answer (B) OMIBEL

Each pair of letters is swapped: MA TU RE → AM UT ER and ME NT AL → EM TN LA. So MO BI LE → OM IB EL: OMIBEL.

Q.14 · Answer (C) 109

The second number is three times the first plus 1: 18 × 3 + 1 = 55 and 28 × 3 + 1 = 85. Likewise 36 × 3 + 1 = 109.

Q.17 · Answer (C) +, ÷, –, ×, =

17 + 18 ÷ 6 – 5 × 2 = 17 + 3 – 10 = 10.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Both conclusions II and III follow.

Every alpha is a beta and no beta is a gamma, so no alpha is a gamma (III), and I cannot follow. The thetas that are alphas are betas, so some thetas are betas (II).

Q.19 · Answer (D) 1163

The differences are 169, 144, 121, 100: 13^2, 12^2, 11^2, 10^2. The next is 9^2 = 81: 1244 – 81 = 1163.

Q.20 · Answer (A) ×,+,÷,–,+,=

17 × 4 + 63 ÷ 7 – 21 + 3 = 68 + 9 – 21 + 3 = 59.

Q.21 · Answer (A) 121
The second term is the square of a third of the first: $(27 \div 3)^2 = 81$ and $(18 \div 3)^2 = 36$. Likewise $(33 \div 3)^2 = 121$.

Q.23 · Answer (D) YJUC
The first letters move +6 (G, M, S, Y, E), the second +7 (O, V, C, J, Q), the third +8 (W, E, M, U, C) and the fourth +9 (B, K, T, C, L), wrapping round after Z: YJUC.

Q.24 · Answer (D) ×, =, ×, ×
$25 \times 3 = 5 \times 15 \times 1$: both sides are 75.

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.2 · Answer (B) ₹6,000
With ₹x at 8%: $0.08x + 0.10(10{,}000 - x) = 880$, so $1{,}000 - 0.02x = 880$ and x = ₹6,000.

Q.4 · Answer (D) ₹200
The selling price is 80% of ₹280 = ₹224, which is 112% of the cost price: $224 \div 1.12$ = ₹200.

Q.5 · Answer (C) ₹62,986
$50{,}000 \times 1.08^3 = 50{,}000 \times 1.259712$ = ₹62,985.60, which is ₹62,986 to the nearest rupee.

Q.6 · Answer (A) 30 km/h
200/24 = 25/3 m/s, and $25/3 \times 18/5 = 30$ km/h.

Q.8 · Answer (D) 162
48 : 72 = 108 : x, so $x = 72 \times 108 \div 48 = 162$.

Q.9 · Answer (B) 2500
The winner had 70% of the votes and the loser 30%; the 40% gap is 900 votes, so 2,250 voted. That is 90% of the list: $2{,}250 \div 0.9 = 2{,}500$.

Q.12 · Answer (B) 478656
A number divisible by 24 is divisible by both 3 and 8. 478656 has digit sum 36, a multiple of 3, and ends in 656 = 8 × 82. The other numbers' digit sums (43, 23, 23) are not multiples of 3.

Q.13 · Answer (B) 57.5 km/h
He covered $50 + 3 \times 60 = 230$ km in 4 hours: $230 \div 4 = 57.5$ km/h.

Q.14 · Answer (C) 84
6 men = 2 women = 4 boys, so a woman does the work of 3 men and a boy that of 1.5. The work is $6 \times 77 = 462$ man-days, and 1 man, 1 woman and 1 boy equal 5.5 men: $462 \div 5.5 = 84$ days.

Q.15 · Answer (A) 100%
Take 100 items costing ₹1 each. A 28% overall profit means ₹128 from the 64 items sold: ₹2 each, 100% above cost.

Q.16 · Answer (D) 12 cm
$6^3 + 8^3 + 10^3 = 216 + 512 + 1{,}000 = 1{,}728 = 12^3$, so the new cube's side is 12 cm.

Q.19 · Answer (D) $150\sqrt{3}$ cm²
A regular hexagon is six equilateral triangles: $6 \times (\sqrt{3}/4) \times 10^2 = 150\sqrt{3}$ cm².

Q.21 · Answer (A) 3m + 2
$9m^2 + 12m + 4 = (3m)^2 + 2 \times 3m \times 2 + 2^2 = (3m + 2)^2$, so the side is 3m + 2.

Q.24 · Answer (D) frequency distribution
A frequency distribution sets out the values of a variable together with the frequency of each.

Q.25 · Answer (A) 7 cm
The two tangents drawn to a circle from an external point are equal, so TQ = TP = 7 cm.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (B) Untouchable
'Untouchable' (1935), Mulk Raj Anand's first novel, follows a day in the life of Bakha, a young sweeper, and exposes the cruelty of the caste system. 'Coolie', 'The Village' and 'Across the Black Waters' are also his, on other themes.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC)
The Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC) was set up in 1988 by the WMO and UNEP to assess the science of climate change.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Kaveri River
The Kaveri (Cauvery), called Ponni in Tamil, rises at Talakaveri in Karnataka's Western Ghats and flows south-east through Karnataka and Tamil Nadu to the Bay of Bengal.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Cricket
An 'off break' is a cricket delivery bowled by an off-spinner, turning from the off side towards the leg side.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Premchand
'Kafan' (The Shroud) is by Premchand; strictly it is a short story rather than a novel.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Liquidity trap
In a liquidity trap the interest rate is so low that people would rather hold any extra money than bonds, so the speculative demand for money becomes perfectly elastic and monetary policy loses its force.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Rickey Kej
The composer Ricky Kej shared the 2015 Grammy for Best New Age Album with the South African flautist Wouter Kellerman for 'Winds of Samsara'.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Gautam Adani
The three Indians on TIME's 100 Most Influential People of 2021 were Narendra Modi, Mamata Banerjee and Adar Poonawalla; Gautam Adani was not on that list.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Ustad Bundu Khan
Ustad Bundu Khan was a celebrated sarangi player. T. N. Krishnan was a violinist, and T. Brinda and T. M. Krishna are Carnatic vocalists.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Pingali Venkayya
Pingali Venkayya, born on 2 August 1876, designed the flag on which the Tricolour is based; 2021 marked his 145th birth anniversary.

Q.11 · Answer (A) 51.09%
SSC's key gives 51.09%: the National Institute of Hydrology's land-use figures, as published in 2009, put about 51.09% of India's land under cultivation and 21.81% under forest.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Padma Shri
Sonal Mansingh received the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1987), the Padma Bhushan (1992) and the Padma Vibhushan (2003), but not the Padma Shri.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Bismillah Khan
Ustad Bismillah Khan brought the shehnai to the concert stage and played it at the Red Fort to mark Independence in August 1947.

Q.14 · Answer (B) M C Mary Kom
'Unbreakable' (2013) is the autobiography of the boxer M. C. Mary Kom.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Tennis
The Davis Cup is the international men's team competition in tennis.

Q.16 · Answer (D) Substances that are steam volatile
Steam distillation separates substances that are volatile in steam and do not mix with water, such as aniline, from non-volatile impurities.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Hydrochloric acid
The stomach's gastric juice contains hydrochloric acid, which kills germs and gives the acidic medium in which pepsin digests proteins.

Q.18 · Answer (A) it can kill beneficial insects like honey bees
DDT kills not only pests but also useful insects such as honey bees, and it persists and builds up along food chains.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Begum Akhtar
Begum Akhtar, the great singer of ghazal, dadra and thumri, is remembered as Mallika-e-Ghazal, the Queen of Ghazal.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Kelucharan Mohapatra
Guru Kelucharan Mohapatra, who led the revival of Odissi, was also an accomplished percussionist on the mardala (pakhawaj) and tabla.

Q.21 · Answer (C) Amoeba
Amoeba surrounds its food with pseudopodia and engulfs it in a food vacuole formed from its cell membrane (phagocytosis).

Q.22 · Answer (D) Padma Subrahmanyam
The Bharatanatyam dancer and scholar Padma Subrahmanyam received the Padma Shri in 1981 and the Padma Bhushan in 2003.

Q.23 · Answer (D) 2010
Mallika Sarabhai received the Padma Bhushan in 2010.

Q.24 · Answer (C) Neeraj Chopra
Neeraj Chopra, the Tokyo 2020 javelin champion, was nominated in February 2022 for the Laureus World Breakthrough of the Year award.

Q.25 · Answer (B) Article 22
Article 22 protects against arrest and detention in certain cases: an arrested person must be told the grounds, may consult a lawyer and must be produced before a magistrate within 24 hours.

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